Name: PRANJAL SWARUP BHATNAGAR **Reg. No.:** RA2512703010007
Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 4 | Activities of the Self — Desire, Thought, Expectation

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. Activities of the Self: KNOWING, ASSUMING, RECOGNISING, FULFILFING; and at the level of IMAGINATION: DESIRE (the basic wants/goals — e.g., 'I want happiness'), THOUGHT (the analysis/planning of how to fulfil desires), EXPECTATION (selection, the 'taste' — choosing specific objects/situations, e.g., wanting that particular phone). Behaviour with humans and work with nature are the OUTER EXPRESSION of this inner imagination: what I desire-think-expect inside comes out as my behaviour and work — so correcting imagination corrects conduct.
2. Q2. Three sources of motivation for imagination: PRECONDITIONING — assumptions adopted from society/upbringing unverified ('success = salary'); SENSATION — pull of bodily tastes and excitement (craving tasty food, binge-watching); NATURAL ACCEPTANCE — the Self's own verified inner acceptance (relationship, trust). The first two lead to ENSLAVEMENT: preconditioning enslaves to crowd opinion, sensation enslaves to bodily urges — conduct stays indefinite (partantrata). Natural acceptance leads to SELF-ORGANISATION (swatantrata): imagination aligned with what is naturally acceptable produces definite, harmonious conduct.
3. Q3. The Self is in HARMONY when my imagination (desire-thought-expectation) is aligned with NATURAL ACCEPTANCE — e.g., intending good for others and acting on it: then INTENTION (what I naturally accept for others) and my imagination agree, and I feel peace. The Self is in CONTRADICTION when imagination is driven by preconditioning/sensation against natural acceptance — e.g., wanting to cheat although fairness is naturally acceptable: then intention says one thing, conduct another, producing tension. COMPETENCE is the ability to live out the intention; happiness = intention and imagination in harmony, backed by competence.
4. Q4. DESIRE is the basic want (the 'what' of the goal) — e.g., 'I want to be respected'. EXPECTATION is the selection of a specific object/situation through which the desire is sought (the 'how/taste') — e.g., 'I expect applause after my presentation'. Desire is deeper and constant; expectation is particular and changeable; mistaking expectation for desire makes us depend on specific outcomes.
5. Q5. PRACTICE (5 minutes observing imagination): On observing, I was aware of my imagination only PART of the time — much of it ran automatically. The motivations I noticed: checking messages (sensation), worrying about how my work compares with others' (preconditioning), and planning to help a friend (natural acceptance). The exercise shows that awareness of imagination is the first step to aligning it with natural acceptance.